mentally, to the fetal stage by having "auditors" question them, and if all these misinterpreted impressions were erased, that individual would become "clear" and a very superior human being.

Neither Sprague nor I were in the least impressed. I considered it gibberish.

Then back to New York, and on April 14, I visited Campbell. He would talk of nothing but dianetics. I didn't argue much; I just remained impervious and said I didn't believe it. Finally Campbell said, half in anger and half in jest, "Damn it, Asimov, you have a built-in doubter."

"Thank goodness I do, Mr. Campbell," said I.

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I was back in Boston on April 16, and marked my first test papers. I quickly realized that although I didn't mind giving lectures, I hated giving tests and I loathed marking them. I couldn't stand being responsible for low marks.

Where the questions required short factual answers, the necessity of placing crosses next to some was absolute and not a matter of judgment. I was then spared the feeling of guilt. Questions requiring essay answers, however, were just too much for me, so after my first experience, I always avoided essay questions when I could.

On April 17, I got a letter from Bill Boyd. His job had folded and he would be back at the Medical School in September.

2 7

Occasionally, we would watch television at a friend's home. Even before we had come to Boston, we had watched Milton Berle on two occasions at the Saltzmans. I had not been impressed. My fascination with television on the occasion of my first sight of it had not survived the repetition.

But then on April 22, 1950, we visited the Whipples and, for the first time, we saw Sid Caesar and Imogene Coca in "Your Show of Shows." That was different. To have entertainment like that in your home was a delight. I felt my snobbish antitelevision attitude evaporate, and we began, from that point onward, considering the possibility of getting one for ourselves.

Beyond Campbell